



Two Hand Master Casting Instructor (THMCI) Performance Exam - Evaluation Form

Candidate: _____ Date: _____

Lead Examiner: _____ Location: _____

2nd Examiner: _____ *EDP Participant:* _____

Time Started: _____

Introduction

The THMCI exam is a Certified Master-level exam for two hand casting instructors that focuses on casting two hand lines with longer heads (>55'; 16.8 m) and emphasizes assessment of the candidate's understanding of two hand casting fundamentals, mechanics, and instructional skills.

Pre-Requisite: The THMCI candidate must be a current Fly Fishers International (FFI) Certified Two Hand Casting Instructor (THCI). FFI may waive this prerequisite if the candidate has the equivalent or higher certification from another recognized casting organization such as EFFA, GAIA, AAPGAI, APGAI Ireland, SGAIC, etc. A waiver must be approved prior to the date of the examination. More information can be found [here](#):

Exam Structure: The examination has three sections: **Section 1** (*Casting Performance*), **Section 2** (*Teaching Performance and Fault Demonstration and Correction*), and **Section 3** (*Discussion*). All three sections must be passed to successfully complete the exam. Casting Performance tasks in **Section 1** are split into **A** and **B Tracks**, which are balanced with respect to use of dominant and non-dominant hand tasks. Examiners choose and use a single Track (A or B) throughout the exam. **Section 3's** Discussion focuses on higher level issues related to casting mechanics and principles, teaching methods, fault diagnosis, equipment etc. Discussion Topics for **Section 3** can be found [here](#). The sections will be performed in sequence starting with **Section 1**.

Scoring: Tasks will be scored as P (Pass), B (Borderline), or F (Fail). A task can be scored B when performance is uncertain. Two B scores are equivalent to one F (1B=1/2 F). When a task has multiple parts, all parts must be passed to pass the task.

To pass the Exam the candidate can fail no more than four tasks in total in **Section 1**, fail no more than two tasks within any Group in **Section 1**, must pass all tasks in **Section 2**, and must pass **Section 3's** Discussion, which will be scored in the aggregate by the Examiner Team as a pass or fail.

Equipment Requirements:

- All equipment will be supplied by the candidate. The candidate is responsible for supplying any teaching aids that he/she may elect to use in **Section 2** (Teaching and Fault Correction).
- The candidate is required to perform all the 70 ft. (21.3m), 80 ft. (24.4m), and 100 ft. (30.5m) floating line tasks with one rod and one floating line. A separate rod and line may be used for the Sink Tip / Sunk Line tasks in Group 8. Candidates may use either or both of the rod and line set ups for the various Teaching and Fault Diagnosis tasks in Section 2.
- **Rod:** Will not exceed 15 feet in length (4.6m). The candidate may use a separate rod set up specifically for the Sink Tip / Sunk Line tasks in Group 8 and the Teaching/Fault Diagnosis section.
- **Fly Lines:** Will be commercial production lines available to the general public. All tasks and casts are to be performed with a floating line, except when tasks are specified differently.
- **Floating Line:** Will be an AFFTA rated Spey line, not greater than 10 wt, two hand line:
 - 680 grains (44.1 grams) at 55-60 ft (16.8m – 18.3m) for short belly lines;
 - 720 grains (46.7 grams) at 65 ft (19.8m) for mid length belly lines;
 - 860 grains (55.7 grams) at 80 ft (24.4 m) for long belly lines.

In order to assure a line has ample length, a head length of 55-60 feet (16.8 -18.3m) or longer is suggested (*the working line from rod tip to fly line and leader connection*).

- **Sink Tip Line:** The candidate may use a Skagit line system, a multi-tip shooting head or integrated line, a loop-to-loop connection line, or a full sinking type (class) 2 line. The sink-tip portion of the line must be a minimum of 15 ft (4.6m), weigh 150 grains (9.7 grams) or more, and be rated as 6-7 ips, type 6, T-8, or greater.
- **Leader/Fly:** The floating line will have a leader no shorter than 10 ft. (3.05m) and no longer than 15 feet (4.6m). The sink-tip line has no leader length restriction. A visible marker of yarn shall be used as a fly.

General Information:

- **Exam Site Location** – The Exam will be conducted on moving or still water. Tasks noted as left bank or right bank will be performed as if from that bank. All other tasks not specifically noted as left or right bank casts, may be candidate's choice of bank or rod hand. Bank definitions are:

River site

Left bank = Face downstream, so that bank is on the left side and river to the right.

Right bank = Face downstream, so that bank is on the right side and river to the left.

Still water site

Left bank = Candidate faces their chosen downstream direction, so that shoreline is on the left side and water to the right.

Right bank = Candidate faces their chosen downstream direction, so that shoreline is on the right side and water to the left.

- **Line Marking** – The candidate's floating line will be marked by measuring the line along a tape from reel to yarn fly to the minimum required casting distances of 70 ft. (21.3m), 80 ft. (24.4m), and 100 ft. (30.5m). Mark the line at each of these distances with a felt pen at the reel. The line used for the sink tip tasks will be marked at 90 ft. (27.4m).
- **Positioning of Line Mark** – When casting, the line mark for the floating line casts of 70 ft. (21.3m) and 80 ft. (24.4m) will be positioned halfway between the reel and the first stripping guide. The candidate may also place the line mark further out the rod, if desired. For all floating line casts of 100 ft. (30.5m) and all sink tip casts of 90 ft. (27.4m), after the cast is made, the

line mark should be at the midway point between the reel and first stripping guide (or further).

- For floating line tasks that require shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) and sink tip/Skagit line tasks to 90 ft. (27.4m), the initial line length is at the discretion of the candidate.
- The examiners will only read candidates the initial text of tasks and not required performance standards and expectations. Candidates are expected to know the exam very well but may request additional parts of the tasks to be read to them.
- Once the examination has started, no one may coach the candidate at any time.
- Casting direction will be at the discretion of the candidate. If a significant change in conditions occurs, the candidate may elect to change the direction of the casts.
- Where not specified, river bank and upper hand is candidate's choice.
- Various casting styles are permitted, provided the cast meets the performance standards of the examination.
- Off-shoulder (cack-hand) casting is not permitted.
- The **Connection Point** for anchored casts is the tip of the fly line (*i.e., the line-leader connection*). The connection between the Scandi floating line and leader is readily visible. For Skagit line casts, the Connection Point will be between the highly visible Skagit line and the dark-colored sink tip.
- Point P is the location where the fly line or leader suspended from the rod tip first touches the water surface.
- The loop width for all casts (*Overhead and Anchored*) will be approximately 3 ft. (0.9m) and measured 4 to 5 ft. (1.2m-1.5m) back from the front of the nose of the loop.
- The **Snap C** is considered synonymous with the Circle C and Circle Spey casts for this exam.
- A false cast is a forward cast followed by a back cast, both of which remain aerialized.
- The candidate may not use or refer to notes of any kind (written or electronic) during the examination.
- During **Section 2** (*Teaching Performance and Fault Demonstration and Correction*), one member of the examiner team will act as a student for instructional purposes in the three Teaching Tasks that require teaching a student.
- One member of the examiner team will be available to serve as a student for the candidate as needed. The candidate may utilize teaching aids to assist in teaching demonstrations.
- Demonstrations must match explanations.
- Several of the terms used in the exam, including those for different anchored casts and loop shapes, can be found in the [Current Version of the FFI Fly Casting Definitions](#). Candidates and examiners are expected to be familiar with the defined terms which appear in this examination.

General Performance Standards

The candidate must demonstrate the high standard of performance expected of a Two Hand Master Casting Instructor, that would instill confidence in students and other instructors. The casts are expected to be formed smoothly with well-formed D-loops (*or V-loops*), relatively straight anchor placements, and have well-formed forward loops that unroll completely, straightening the leader unless otherwise asked for.

Candidates should successfully complete tasks in no more than three attempts, with good demonstrations, and with clear and concise explanations. Candidates should expect that examiners might ask them to expand or give greater detail on any task in order to confirm knowledge or skills.

Performance standards for front loops and back D/V loops are summarized in the table below. Performance standards for overhead and roll casts are described in those tasks.

Except when faults are to be demonstrated or identified, or where the task specifies otherwise, the following requirements will apply to all sections of the examination.

Performance Standards	Front loop:	D/V loop:
Have a relatively straight fly leg.	✓	
Have minimal slack in the rod leg.	✓	✓
Loops approximately 3 ft. (0.91m) in width or less.	✓	
Loops will not be tailing and should be approximately in-plane.	✓	
In all forward casts, the fly line and leader will unroll completely and be relatively straight	✓	
All casts will be made so they can be easily assessed for loop shape and width by the examiners	✓	✓
All casts will have an anchor, D/V Loop, and forward cast that are approximately in lateral alignment (<i>i.e., the 180-degree principle for anchored casts</i>)	✓	✓
Line tension will be maintained appropriately throughout the casting sequence.	✓	✓
Anchors should have minimal slack and will be laid out relatively straight and tight in alignment with the forward cast.		✓
The majority of the anchor (<i>Point P to yarn fly</i>) for Switch and Spey casts should normally be in front of the caster within the anchor placement zone after D/V loop formation. 'In front of' means in front of an imaginary line that is centered on the caster and is perpendicular (90 degrees) to the casting direction (<i>i.e., the target line</i>). <i>See Diagram on last page of exam: Anchor Position Guidelines</i>		✓

Candidate's Equipment:

Rod: 15ft. (4.57m) rod maximum.

Rod length: _____

Line: 10-wt maximum.

Line weight: _____

Leader: 10 - 15 ft. (3.05m – 4.57m) with yarn fly

Leader length: _____

Sinking/Sunk Line type/model: _____ **Head length:** _____

Examiners verified line markings and distances **Y / N** _____

THMCI Exam Section 1 – Casting Performance

(up to 1 hr, 45 min)

Group 1 – Overhead Casts

Time Started: _____

- General information and performance standard as previously described.
- Must be performed with both back cast and forward cast over water.

Required Performance Standards:

- Loops must be:
 - Similar in width and shape between the forward and back casts.
 - Have a relatively straight fly leg (except for the wide and tailing loop tasks).
 - Have minimal slack in the rod leg.
 - Be in-plane, after making allowances for wind and gravity (except on Task 5).
 - Made so they can be easily assessed for shape and width by the examiners.
 - Approximately 3 ft. (0.9m) in width or less for narrow loops.
 - Approximately 6 ft. (2.4m) in width or more for wide loops.
- No ticking (the fly, line, or leader hitting the water before the final forward delivery).
- Loops must not be tailing; except as required by a performance or teaching task.

- ___ 1. Demonstrate 3-4 false casts at 70 ft. (21.3m). Right hand up.
() Tailing loop () Ticks () Loops Out-of-Plane () Inconsistent loop width
() First back cast loop too wide
Comments:
- ___ 2. Demonstrate 3-4 false casts at 70 ft. (21.3m). Left hand up.
() Tailing loop () Loops Out-of-Plane () Ticks () Inconsistent loop width
() First back cast loop too wide
Comments:
- ___ 3. Explain and demonstrate loop size. Demonstrate wide loops followed by narrow loops in 3-4 false casts at 70 ft. (21.3m).
() Explanation unclear or incomplete () Loops Out-of-Plane () Tailing loop () Ticks
() No variation in loop width () Poor demonstration
Comments:
- ___ 4. Demonstrate a tailing loop on command. Explain more than one way a tailing loop can be formed, and their corrections. () Poor demonstration () Explanation unclear or incomplete
Comments:
- ___ 5. Without false casting, demonstrate an Overhead Change of Direction Cast (30 degrees or greater) at 70 ft. (21.3m).
() Fails to make > 30 degree change () Multiple false casts used () Ticks
Comments:
- ___ 6. After one or more false casts, demonstrate an Overhead Cast shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m).
() Fails to reach 100 ft. (30.5m) () Tailing loop () Loops Out-of-Plane () Loops fail to unroll
Comments:

Group 2 – Roll Casts

Time Started: _____

Required Performance Standards:

- D-loop will be formed slowly enough so that the line does not leave the water's surface; however, it can continue moving backwards prior to the forward cast.
- The D-loop will not extend more than one arm plus one rod length behind the caster.
- Stepping backwards or forwards during the formation of the D-loop is not permitted.
- Loop width shall be approximately 3 ft. (0.9m) or less with a relatively straight top leg, and with the leader straightening completely on delivery.

- ___ 1. Demonstrate a Roll Cast at 70 ft. (21.3m) without shooting line. Right hand up.
() Poor alignment () Leader did not straighten fully () Loops too wide () Loops Out-of-Plane

Comments:

- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Roll Cast at 70 ft. (21.3m) without shooting line. Left hand up.
() Poor alignment () Leader did not straighten fully () Loops too wide () Loops Out-of-Plane
Comments:

Group 3 – Switch Casts

Time Started: _____

- Candidate will perform either **Track A** or **Track B** chosen previously by examiners.

Required Performance Standards:

- The initial lift and sweep prior to placement of the anchor must completely lift the fly line, leader, and fly off the water.
- No change of direction is permitted.
- Dragging or skipping the anchor into position is not permitted.

Track A (2 tasks)

- ___ 1. Explain and demonstrate a Switch Cast with D-loops at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line. Right hand up.
() Explanation unclear or incomplete () Lack of continuous tension () Poor demonstration
() Tailing loop () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Switch Cast with V-loops at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line. Left hand up.
() Lack of continuous tension () Poor demonstration () Tailing loop () Poor anchor placement
() Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

Track B (2 tasks)

- ___ 3. Explain and demonstrate a Switch Cast with V-loops at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line. Right hand up.
() Explanation unclear or incomplete () Lack of continuous tension () Poor demonstration
() Tailing loop () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 4. Demonstrate a Switch Cast with D-loops at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line. Left hand up.
() Lack of continuous tension () Poor demonstration () Tailing loop () Poor anchor placement
() Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 5. Explain and demonstrate three different anchor placements: Beside the caster, forward of the caster, and behind the caster. Explain how the different anchor placements affects the casts.
() Poor demonstration () Explanation unclear or incomplete
Comments:

Group 4 – Single Spey

Time Started: _____

- Candidate will perform either **Track A** or **Track B** chosen previously by examiners.

Required Performance Standards:

- The initial lift and sweep prior to placement of the anchor must completely lift the fly line, leader, and fly off the water.
- Dragging or skipping the anchor into position is not permitted.

Track A (2 tasks)

- ___ 1. Demonstrate a Single Spey at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 45 degrees from the right bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Single Spey with a change of direction of 45 degrees, shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) from the left bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

Track B (2 tasks)

- ___ 3. Demonstrate a Single Spey at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 45 degrees from the left bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 4. Demonstrate a Single Spey with a change of direction of 45 degrees, shooting line to 100ft. (30.5m) from the right bank, left hand up. () Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane () Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 5. Demonstrate a Single Spey at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a direction change of 90 degrees or more.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Less than 90 degree change
Comments:

Group 5 – Double Spey

Time Started: _____

- Candidate will perform either **Track A** or **Track B** chosen previously by examiners.

Track A (2 tasks)

- ___ 1. Demonstrate a Double Spey at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees, from the right bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Less than 90 degree change
Comments:

- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Double Spey shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Less than 90 degree change
Comments:

Track B (2 tasks)

- ___ 3. Demonstrate a Double Spey at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees, from the left bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Less than 90 degree change
Comments:
- ___ 4. Demonstrate a Double Spey shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the right bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Less than 90 degree change
Comments:
- ___ 5. Demonstrate a Double Spey at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a direction change of 45 degrees or less.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:
- ___ 6. Explain and demonstrate casting within a minimum backspace of at most 6 ft. (1.85m).
() Poor demonstration () Explanation unclear or incomplete
Comments:

Group 6 – Snake Roll

Time Started: _____

- Candidate will perform either **Track A** or **Track B** chosen previously by examiners.

Track A (2 tasks)

- ___ 1. Demonstrate a Snake Roll at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:
- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Snake Roll shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the right bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

Track B (2 tasks)

- ___ 3. Demonstrate a Snake Roll at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the right bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:
- ___ 4. Demonstrate a Snake Roll shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
Comments:

- ___ 5. Demonstrate a Snake Roll at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a direction change of 45 degrees or less.
 () Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
 () Tailing loop () Loop fails to unroll
 Comments:
- ___ 6. Explain and demonstrate a poorly timed forward cast that begins too early or too late.
 () Explanation unclear or incomplete () Poor demonstration
 Comments:
- ___ 7. Explain and demonstrate a curved anchor resulting from an improper alignment of the "e" or oval during the cast formation.
 () Explanation unclear or incomplete () Poor demonstration
 Comments:

Group 7 – Snap Casts

Time Started: _____

- Candidate will perform either **Track A** or **Track B** chosen previously by examiners.
- Candidate may choose to use a Snap C or a Snap T, as long as both are demonstrated during the group of casts.

Track A (2 tasks)

- ___ 1. Demonstrate a Snap cast at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, right hand up.
 () Fails to reach 80 ft. (24.4m) () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
 () Tailing loop () Loops fail to unroll
 Comments:
- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Snap cast shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the right bank, left hand up.
 () Fails to reach 100 ft. (30.5m) () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
 () Tailing loop () Loops fail to unroll
 Comments:

Track B (2 tasks)

- ___ 3. (4). Demonstrate a Snap cast at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the right bank, left hand up.
 () Fails to reach 80 ft. (24.4m) () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
 () Tailing loop () Loops fail to unroll
 Comments:
- ___ 4. (3). Demonstrate a Snap cast shooting line to 100 ft. (30.5m) with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, right hand up.
 () Fails to reach 100 ft. (30.5m) () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
 () Tailing loop () Loops fail to unroll
 Comments:
- ___ 5. Demonstrate a Snap cast at 80 ft. (24.4m) without shooting line with a direction change of 45 degrees or less.
 () Fails to reach 80 ft. (24.4m) () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
 () Tailing loop () Loops fail to unroll
 Comments:

Group 8 – Sink Tip or Sunk Line Performance Tasks

Time Started: _____

Tasks in this Group require the candidate to demonstrate a Double Spey, a Snap cast (Snap T or Snap C), and a Single Spey with a sink tip shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m).

- General information, performance standard and equipment requirements as previously described.
- Candidate will perform either **Track A** or **Track B** chosen previously by examiners.

Track A (3 tasks – all Right Bank)

- ___ 1. Demonstrate a Double Spey shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m) at 90 degrees, right bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Did not make 90-degree change () Did not achieve 90 ft. (27.4m) distance
Comments:

- ___ 2. Demonstrate a Snap cast shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m) at 90 degrees, right bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Did not make 90-degree change () Did not achieve 90 ft. (27.4m) distance
Comments:

- ___ 3. Demonstrate a Single Spey shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m); delivery at 60 degrees, right bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Did not make 60-degree change () Did not achieve 90 ft. (27.4m) distance
Comments:

Track B (3 tasks – all Left Bank)

- ___ 4. Demonstrate a Double Spey shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m) at 90 degrees, left bank, left hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Did not make 90-degree change () Did not achieve 90 ft. (27.4m) distance
Comments:

- ___ 5. Demonstrate a Snap cast shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m) at 90 degrees, left bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Did not make 90-degree change () Did not achieve 90 ft. (27.4m) distance
Comments:

- ___ 6. Demonstrate a Single Spey shooting line to 90 ft. (27.4m); delivery at 60 degrees, left bank, right hand up.
() Poor demonstration () Poor anchor placement () Poor alignment () Loops Out-of-Plane
() Tailing loop () Did not make 60-degree change () Did not achieve 90 ft. (27.4m) distance
Comments:

THMCI Exam – Section 2:

Teaching Skills and Fault Demonstrations and Corrections (~1 hr)

This section contains eight tasks in total – three teaching tasks, one teaching question requiring an explanation on shooting heads, and four fault correction tasks designed to assess the candidate's ability to give organized, clear, and concise instruction to students using appropriate terminology (based upon the student skill levels described below) and a clear understanding of casting mechanics. The candidate's teaching demonstrations are expected to present a logical teaching progression that, where appropriate, addresses multiple learning styles. Candidates are expected to be engaging, student-centered, confident, and professional in their teaching demonstrations. Teaching tasks focus on Intermediate and advanced level students.

Candidates will be asked to perform one of the teaching tasks from each of the three Groups as selected by the examiners.

- One member of the examiner team will act as a student for instructional purposes in the three Teaching Tasks that require teaching a student.

Candidates will be asked to *demonstrate* and correct four of the seven faults as selected by the examiners.

Definitions for the Teaching Tasks:

Intermediate Student: Has a basic understanding of casting mechanics and has good single hand casting skills. Has used a two hand rod, may know and use Double Spey or Snap Casts, but struggles with consistency and efficiency and is now seeking instruction to improve.

Advanced Student: Has a good understanding of casting mechanics and good loop control as a two hand caster when fishing. Has limited control of the advanced casts and is seeking instruction to improve.

Candidates should assume that students have the skills required to learn the tasks they are being taught. Line lengths are at the discretion of the candidate.

Scoring of Teaching Tasks:

Teaching tasks will be scored using the four domains scorecard below, with candidate performance for each domain noted in the P-B-F scoring system used for casting performance tasks. However, the final score for the task is noted as either P (Pass) or F (Fail). Within the teaching task, a fail score in a single domain (or two borderline scores in two domains) constitutes an F (Fail) for that task. A successful candidate may not fail any of the tasks in **Section 2**.

Performance Standards for the Teaching Tasks:

Communication Effectiveness	Content Knowledge	Teaching Methodology	Teaching Style
• Clear and Concise • Organized • Awareness of Student Progress (monitoring and adjusting)	• Appropriate Terminology • Understanding of Casting Mechanics	• Logical Progression • Breaks into Steps • Addresses Multiple Learning Styles (where appropriate)	• Engaging • Student Centered • Confident • Professional

A. Teaching Performance Tasks:*(30 minutes total; ~10 minutes /group)**Time Started: _____*

___ **Group 1.** The candidate is required to teach a member of the examiner team one of the following tasks:

- Teach an intermediate student a Double Spey cast without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, left hand up.
- Teach an intermediate student a Snap cast without shooting line, with a change of direction of 90 degrees from the left bank, right hand up.

Communication Effectiveness	Content Knowledge	Teaching Methodology	Teaching Style	Teaching Task Pass/Fail
P B F	P B F	P B F	P B F	P F

Comments:

___ **Group 2.** The candidate is required to teach a member of the examiner team one of the following tasks:

- Teach an advanced student to improve when Single Spey distance casting with a change of direction of 60 degrees or more.
- Teach and explain the uses of a Snake Roll to an intermediate student without shooting line, with a direction change of 45 degrees or less.

Communication Effectiveness	Content Knowledge	Teaching Methodology	Teaching Style	Teaching Task Pass/Fail
P B F	P B F	P B F	P B F	P F

Comments:

___ **Group 3.** The candidate is required to teach a member of the examiner team one of the following tasks:

- Teach an intermediate student the importance of the lift and sweep in anchor placement in the Switch Cast. Include drills and practice steps you would use to help a student who is struggling with this sequence?
- Teach an intermediate student the mechanics and steps for a successful anchor placement and alignment of the D-loop when casting a Single Spey to 45 degrees or more.

Communication Effectiveness	Content Knowledge	Teaching Methodology	Teaching Style	Teaching Task Pass/Fail
P B F	P B F	P B F	P B F	P F

Comments:

B. Teaching Explanation Task:

(10 minutes)

___ 1. An intermediate-advanced TH caster has approached you. They have been fishing short Skagit lines with sinking tips for several years (head length of ~23 ft.; 7.0m). They are preparing for a trip to target salmon / steelhead using skating flies with floating Scandi lines and request help in gaining casting proficiency with the longer head Scandi lines (head length of 40-45 ft; 12.2-13.7m).

- Explain the changes in casting mechanics and principles you would teach your student in moving from the short compact Skagit system to the floating Scandi Long line.
- Describe how fundamental elements of the two hand cast (i.e., the lift, sweep, D loop formation, circle up, forward cast, use of top and bottom hands, etc.) might differ when casting the two different line systems.
- Discuss how these differences apply relative to sustained anchor casts (Double Spey / Snap Cast) and touch-and-go casts (Single Spey / Snake Roll).

C. Fault Demonstration and Correction

(20 minutes; 5 minutes per fault)

Time Started: _____

The candidate is required to demonstrate **four** of the following faults as selected by the examination team and then describe and demonstrate the appropriate corrections. The candidate must pass all four selected fault tasks.

Expectations:

- Demonstration of the fault by the candidate should clearly and accurately reflect the fault selected.
- The candidate should then correct the fault through explanation and demonstration. All corrective explanations should be based on line/rod/caster relationships.

Fault Task 1: The candidate is required to demonstrate **one** of the following faults as selected by the examination team. The candidate will then describe and demonstrate the appropriate corrections.

- a) Single Spey cast with a bloody L pointing away from the caster (upstream) or blown anchor.
- b) Snap C or Snap T cast (candidate's choice), where anchor placement is too far upstream or downstream (examiners choose which).

Comments:

Fault Task 2: The candidate is required to demonstrate **two** of the following faults as selected by the examination team. The candidate will then describe and demonstrate the appropriate corrections.

- a) Wide loop with convex fly leg due to leading with the top hand.
- b) Poor anchor and D Loop formation due to level line drop.
- c) A concave fly leg (or tailing loop) preceded by creep.

Comments:

Fault Task 3: The candidate is required to demonstrate **one** of the following faults as selected by the examination team. The candidate will then describe and demonstrate the appropriate corrections.

- a) Inefficient (and dangerous) D Loop formation due to Hooking in a Double Spey.
- b) Poor D loop formation due to a dipping or downward rod tip path during the D loop sweep in a Snap Cast.

Comments:

THMCI Exam – Section 3: Discussion

(up to 30 minutes)

Time Started: _____

After the candidate passes **Section 2**, the examiners will conduct **Section 3** (Discussion). This is an instructor-to-instructor dialogue with the candidate that explores the candidate's depth of knowledge on the topics listed below (in priority order), especially as related to two hand casting:

- Fly casting principles and mechanics.
- Teaching and instructional methods.
- Fault recognition, diagnosis, and corrections.
- Fly fishing equipment.
- Fly fishing techniques.
- Etiquette while fly fishing, including on-stream, wading, and fishing from boats.

Examiners will raise up to six topics for discussion. Up to two topics may relate to issues relevant to the candidate's exam performance. The remaining topics will come from across the various topic categories in the **THMCI Discussion Topics** list. [Click here](#) for the topics.

Performance Standards: The candidate is expected to demonstrate substantial knowledge and understanding based on both the available fly casting and fishing literature and his or her own experience. The candidate's responses should be clear and concise, demonstrate appropriate depth of knowledge, and explain complex topics simply both for students and other instructors. Finally, a candidate must have confidence in his or her viewpoints and be prepared to support them as needed.

Examiners will score **Section 3** in aggregate as a Pass or Fail.

Anchor Position Guidelines

Diagram A is a generalized snapshot of the anchor and D loop placement after D loop formation.

Anchor: The fly and leader/fly line in contact with the water at the bottom of the D Loop (Point P to the fly).
The dashed curved line in Diagram A represents a leader that is acceptable as relatively straight.

Connection Point: The line/leader or line/sink tip connection. (Diagrams A and B).

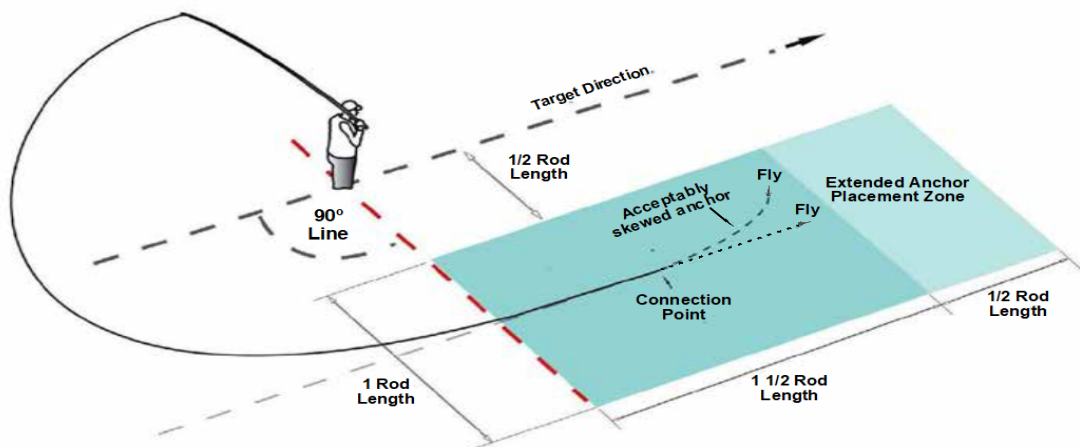
Point P: The point where the fly line suspended from the rod tip first touches the water. Point P moves during the casting sequence, as well as during the initial lift (Diagram C).

Anchor Placement Zone: Area within which the majority of the anchor should normally be placed (Diagrams A and B).

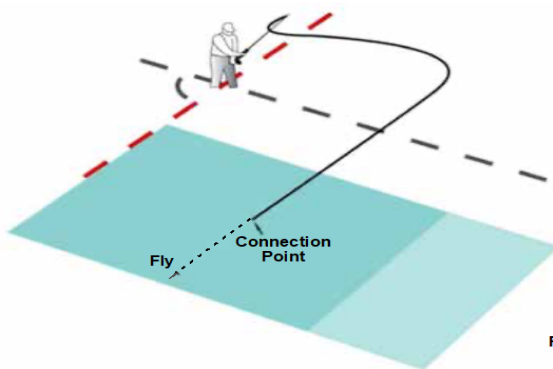
Extended Anchor Placement Zone: Area in front of the anchor placement zone used for locating the front portion of the anchor when adjusting for limited back space for the D-loop (Diagram A).

90-Degree Line: An imaginary line centered on the caster and perpendicular (90 degrees) to the target direction.

A) Anchor placement after D Loop formation



B) Line placement in a Sustained Anchor or Two-Stage Cast prior to the sweep and formation of the D loop



C) Point P moves away from the caster during a lift

